GET INVOLVED

How to Participate

Phase 0 is the right moment to ask questions, raise concerns, and help shape what comes next. There is no single path to getting involved.

Village Residents & Landowners

Your land, local knowledge, and voice are essential. Join the community consultation process and help shape the design of what is built here.

Forestry & Energy Professionals

Technical review, feasibility input, and partnership in implementation of forest restoration and energy systems.

Investors & Philanthropists

Phase 0 funding for feasibility studies, legal structure, and early community outreach. Impact-first approach.

Researchers & Academics

Collaborate on open data, carbon measurement, rural energy modelling, and ecological monitoring.

Other Rural Communities

Everything built here is documented and shared openly — free for any village facing the same challenges to replicate and adapt.

JINJA FESTIVAL

VILLAGE EVENTS

Mitsue.

ECOLOGY · ENERGY · DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

mitsue.it

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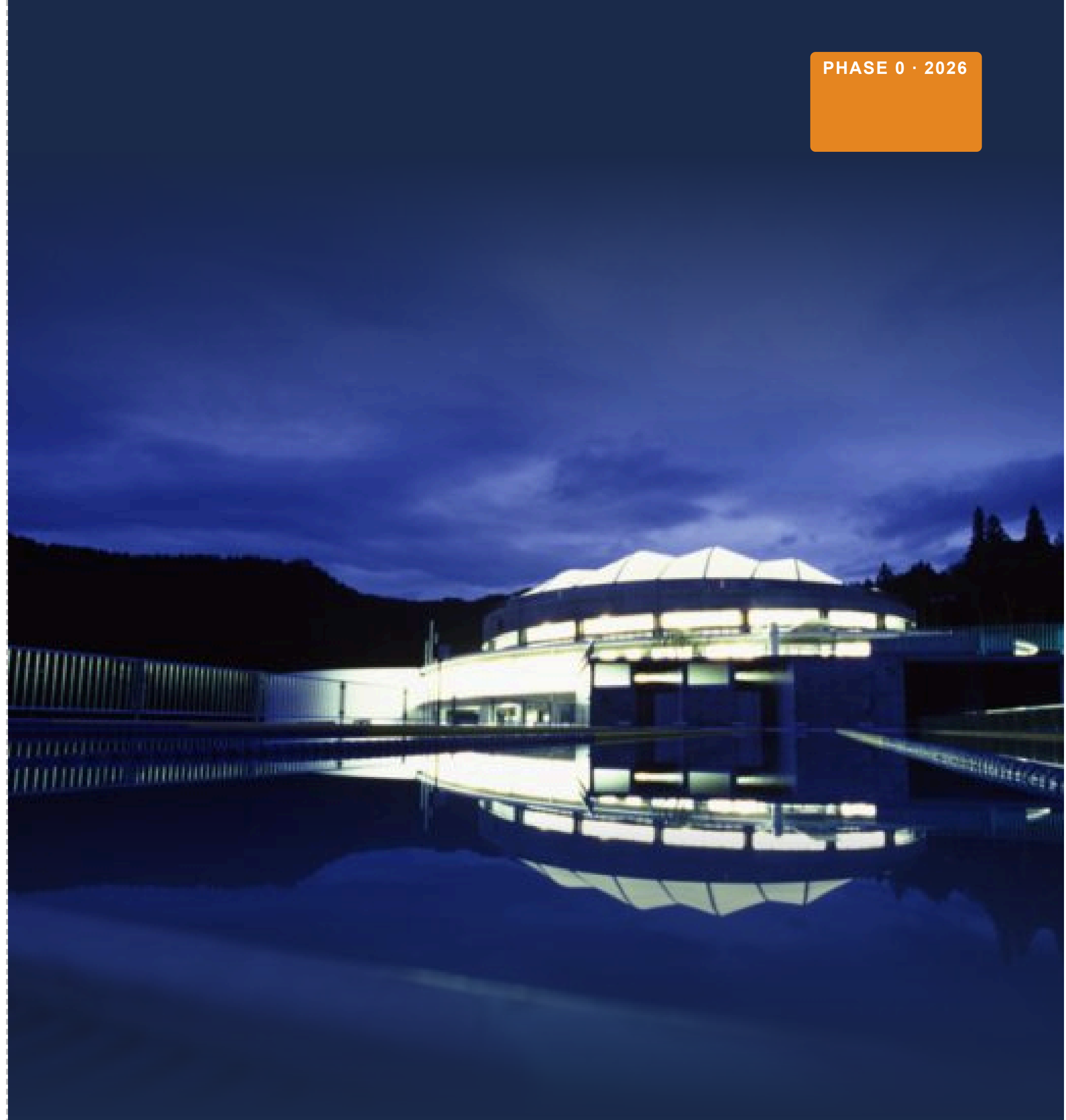
Mitsue Village, Nara Prefecture, Japan

Version 2.1 · May 2026

PHASE 0 · 2026



THE MITSUE PROJECT

Ecology · Energy

Digital Infrastructure for Rural Japan

MITSUE VILLAGE · NARA · JAPAN

THE PROJECT

Three Pillars

Forest Restoration

Aging cedar monoculture replaced with native mixed forest, healing land that has been ecologically depleted for decades. Landowners begin receiving income from timber harvest from Year 2.

EV Charging & Energy Resilience

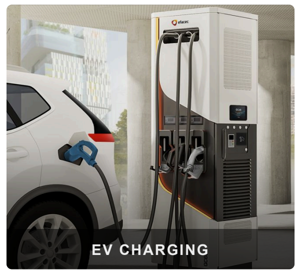
Solar panels and battery storage at the school supply clean local energy, EV charging for residents and visitors, and backup power during grid outages — addressing a real problem already affecting Mitsue today.

Sustainable AI Data Center

A small, efficient digital facility inside the old school, powered entirely by local renewable energy — creating local employment and stable long-term revenue where none existed before.

> *"These are not three separate ideas — each one makes the others possible."*

CEDAR FOREST


EV CHARGING


COMMUNITY

PHASE 0 · NOW OPEN

What We're Building

The closed Mitsue Elementary School and its surrounding cedar forest — transformed into a living model of rural self-sufficiency for Japan and the world.

WHY THIS PLACE?

- ✓ Closed school available for reuse
- ✓ Productive cedar forest within reach
- ✓ River available for natural water cooling
- ✓ Resident engineer with deep local roots since 2012
- ✓ Village leadership open to new ideas
- ✓ Proven open-data ethos from Safecast

FUNDED BY

林野庁 forest grants · METI/NEDO rural energy & EV grants · FIT/FIP feed-in tariff revenues · J-Credit carbon offset income · Data center service revenue · Impact investment & philanthropy

ADVISORS

Joi Ito — Former Director, MIT Media Lab

Ray Ozzie — Former Chief Software Architect, Microsoft

MILESTONES

Timeline

Benefits arrive well before Year 25 — the 25-year horizon describes full forest restoration, not how long the village waits for results.

Year 1	Closed school reactivated; international media visibility for Mitsue Village
Year 2	Landowners begin receiving income from cedar harvest
Year 3–4	EV charging stations operational; battery storage installed for village blackout resilience
Year 4–5	Data center operational; local jobs in operations & maintenance created
Year 5–10	Data service revenue reinvested into village and forest programmes
Year 25	Native mixed forest established; model fully documented and shared openly worldwide

About the Team

Rob Oudendijk — Dutch electrical engineer, resident of Mitsue since 2012. Core hardware developer for *Safecast*, the open citizen science network born after Fukushima, with over 250 million radiation measurements published openly since 2011.

A dedicated non-profit is being established with local residents, village leadership, forestry professionals, and academic partners.